



Power-packed performer: "I want the same energy at the 300th ball as I had at the first," says Jemimah.

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right?

Yes, I remember going as a 16-year-old to pick up the Indian women's team. Until then, hardly anyone followed women's cricket, but that day the airport was packed. That's when I knew women's cricket had made it.

Did the spark for you as a cricketer come then, or was it when you saw M.S. Dhoni lift the 2011 World Cup?

The spark ignited when India won the home World Cup. And my house at that time was just behind Sachin Sir's. So, when he came in his car, I actually saw him coming out, and there was no space for his car to move. It would have taken him three hours just to go less than a kilometre. So, I think, yeah, that's when I was

like, okay, World Cups are special in India.

Would you say missing the 2022 ODI World Cup was both your biggest setback and a major turning point?

Hundred per cent. What they say is true — every setback sets you up for a greater comeback. At the time, being dropped before the World Cup felt like the worst thing that could happen. But looking back, it's one of the best. It forced me to change my game, work on my personality, understand myself better and step out of my comfort zone. That fall has made me a better player today.

Can you elaborate on how you made that turnaround happen?

It was a very difficult time. I used to cry almost every night and was struggling mentally. I even took a short break because I couldn't handle being dropped and missing out on playing for my favourite team. After some time, I sat down with my coach,

Prashant Sir (Shetty), and my dad, who also coaches me. We made a plan: I'd play two matches, but on tough pitches. At Azad Maidan, for example, mornings had so much dew you could press the surface down, and by the afternoon it turned square. I played against quality Mumbai boys — sometimes Under-12s, sometimes U-19s, sometimes older. Stepping out of my comfort zone and training in those conditions helped me understand my game far better. So when I came back to international cricket, where you usually get good batting tracks, it felt much easier.

In that phase, besides your family and cricket support system, who was your biggest source of strength?

Apart from my family and cricket, I'd say God — Jesus — because my faith is built on Him. When everything around me feels uncertain, He is the rock that keeps me steady. I hold on to the belief that something good will